

DoD Performance Management Appraisal Program

DoD PMA Selectable Sections Report

Employee Name KARKI, MOHAN	Position Title T5905900.IT SPECIALIST (NETWORK).997785.NGAF.APPR
PP/SRS/GR/ST GS/2210/11/03	
Rating Official Nee, Jason J	Appraisal Period 08-APR-2024 to 07-APR-2025
Appraisal ID 454228	

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Performance Elements with Progress Review Assessments

ELEMENT NO. 1	TITLE: Vulnerability Remediation
STATUS: APPROVED	
Effective vulnerability remediation is a critical component of any organization's cybersecurity program. By regularly identifying and addressing vulnerabilities, we can reduce the risk of security breaches and ensure that our systems, applications, and networks remain secure over time. Key steps in vulnerability remediation is: Identifying vulnerabilities using ACAS scans, TASKORDs and Dispatch. Prioritize the most severe vulnerabilities that will have the most impact on cyber security. Take steps to remediate issues via patching, update configurations or implementing additional security controls. Verify that remediation has been effective by re-scanning or testing. Document any unusual or reusable techniques that could be valuable later on. A. Review weekly vulnerability reports (SCORE, HBSS, ACAS) and identify trends. B. Check Dispatch daily for new threats and taskers. C. Patch vulnerabilities via scripting, SCCM request or manual means.	
TYPE OF ASSESSMENT: PROGRESS REVIEW	Progress Review Number: 1
EMPLOYEE INPUT	
- Vulnerability Remediation Performance I consistently deliver exceptional vulnerability remediation results, ensuring robust system security through collaborative efforts with cross-functional teams. My key activities and accomplishments include: I perform daily vulnerability scanning and prioritization using ACAS & ARAD, and review and analyze vulnerability reports with my team. We collaborate on planning and discussing remediation strategies, develop, test, and refine PowerShell scripts for patching and remediation, and verify remediation effectiveness through re-scanning and testing. Additionally, I document best practices and reusable techniques for team knowledge sharing and coordinate with CFP, SCOO, SCOI, and SCXS for enhanced security controls. My notable accomplishments include successfully identifying and remediating critical vulnerabilities, improving patching efficiency through scripted solutions, expanding my cybersecurity expertise through research and training, and fostering effective collaboration with CFP, SCOO, SCOI, and SCXS. Notably, our CORA rating has significantly decreased in the NIPR network, as reflected in the weekly ACAS Vulnerability Posture Dashboard, largely attributed to my proactive remediation efforts, which significantly contribute to team success. - Professional Development Despite initially dedicating over five months to obtaining necessary system authorizations, approvals, certifications, and security clearances, I have rapidly progressed in my role. In less than two months of actively working on vulnerability remediation tasks, I have made significant strides in cybersecurity, network security, and scripting. My swift adaptation and continuous learning demonstrate my commitment to growth and excellence. - Future Plans I aim to refine vulnerability remediation processes, explore automation opportunities, and strengthen collaboration with other units.	
RATING OFFICIAL ASSESSMENT	
Mr. Karki has worked hard to become qualified to work on the network as an admin. It can be a long process but he endured through the process. He has made a significant impact on the vulnerability scores and we continue to improve. Well done!	

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ELEMENT NO. 2	TITLE: STIG Compliance
STATUS: APPROVED	
The importance of Security Technical Implementation Guides (STIGs) lies in their ability to provide a comprehensive and detailed set of security configuration guidelines that can help organizations improve their overall security posture. STIGs can help us improve security and reduce the risk of a security breach by improving our overall security posture. They help us maintain compliance with Air Force regulations. Additionally, we can improve efficiency by complying to the Air Forces standardized approach to security configurations, reducing the time and resources required to secure our systems and networks. A. Conduct PC SCAP scans monthly by group. B. Conduct SCAP scans/firmware checks on 5 printers each month. C. Analyze/Document results and compare scans against baseline and previous scans monthly for records/trend analysis. D. Conduct annual review with Infrastructure on all switches for STIG compliance.	
TYPE OF ASSESSMENT: PROGRESS REVIEW	Progress Review Number: 1
EMPLOYEE INPUT	
- STIGs Compliance I consistently demonstrate proactive progress in STIGs implementation, initiating foundational steps despite pending training and certification requirements. Through collaboration with authorized team members, I've gained understanding of benchmark requirements outlined in STIGs official documentation (DISA), Air Force Cybersecurity guidance, and NIST SP 800-171 (security controls). I've actively participated in analyzing Air Force-provided benchmarks using SCAP scans, assessing our base's security posture against established standards. By working alongside experienced team members, I've contributed to applying system hardening measures and configurations to mitigate risks. Notably, our team's collective efforts have enhanced security compliance. I'm committed to completing STIG training and certification, obtaining admin access, and leading future implementation efforts. - Professional Development Enhancing STIGs expertise in security configuration, compliance, and vulnerability mitigation. Future plans include STIGs certification and exploring emerging security threats.	
RATING OFFICIAL ASSESSMENT	
Mr. Karki has made strides in learning the AF STIG processes and guidelines. They don't always make things clear, but he has done an outstanding job navigating through processes to further understand how to implement the STIGs. Keep up your progress and I'm sure you will be the local expert in no time!	

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ELEMENT NO. 3	TITLE: Stand-alone system/program management
STATUS: APPROVED	
Managing a stand-alone system is essential for maintaining system security, performance and reliability. It can help prevent issues before they become critical. Regular maintenance can also help ensure the system remains up to date and compliant with Air Force regulations and standards. A. Identify and track all stand alone systems and machines on base. B. Ensure that a compliance review is completed quarterly on all stand-alone systems. This includes being scanned, conduct vulnerability assessment and ensure STIGs are implemented.	
TYPE OF ASSESSMENT: PROGRESS REVIEW	Progress Review Number: 1
EMPLOYEE INPUT	
- Standalone System Management Transformed standalone system management from ground zero to a robust tracking system. Established a comprehensive database through thorough outreach via email, phone, and in-person interviews. Mapped standalone systems, detailing user information, purpose and usage, installed software, system administrators, and deployment dates. Enhanced visibility and support for mission-critical systems, enabling targeted vulnerability remediation and STIG compliance. - Future Plans: Verify reported systems through unit visits and obtain Authorization to Operate (ATO) documents for compliance with DISA STIG, Air Force Cybersecurity, NIST SP 800-171, and DoD Instruction 8500.01. - Professional Development: Expanding expertise in standalone system management, security, and compliance.	
RATING OFFICIAL ASSESSMENT	
The tracking of local/standalone systems has been one of our weaknesses for a long time. Mr. Karki has done an outstanding job tracking down unreported systems for tracking and ensuring AF compliance. This is no easy feat, but his persistence has moved things along and we will have ATOs for these systems in the future.	

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ELEMENT NO. 4	TITLE: Functional Mission Assurance for Cyber
STATUS: APPROVED	
FMA-C is an essential risk management activity to identify and manage cyber risk on our network and ensuring we are mission capable. This can be achieved by conducting risk assessments, developing risk management plans and implementing risk mitigation strategies. A. Review DISPATCH at least twice a week for new taskers. B. Update local tracker and brief status to leadership weekly. C. Create and execute PMI checklists for daily, weekly and monthly maintenance items.	
TYPE OF ASSESSMENT: PROGRESS REVIEW	Progress Review Number: 1
EMPLOYEE INPUT	
- FMA-C Performance I actively support Functional Mission Assurance for Cyber, complementing critical tasks like Vulnerability Remediation, STIGs Compliance, and Standalone System Management. While pursuing necessary training, certification, and authorization, I collaborate with experienced team members to understand FMA-C principles and develop plans to achieve mission assurance. I attend training sessions and work closely with authorized team members to gain practical knowledge. - Professional Development I'm advancing FMA-C knowledge through training and mentorship, positioning myself for future certification and authorization. I aim to complete training, obtain certification, and gain authorization to access systems, enhancing team capabilities and mission assurance.	
RATING OFFICIAL ASSESSMENT	
Mr. Karki has completed the FMA-C course. Mr. Karki gets the information from DISPATCH from co-workers, but will need to make sure he learns how to get in there and know what information is relevant to the workcenter. I would also like to see some scheduled PMIs come out of the workcenter. Good job overall.	

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ELEMENT NO. 5	TITLE: Continuous Process Improvement and Innovation
STATUS: APPROVED	
CPI is essential for maintaining a competitive advantage, improving efficiency and quality, and complying with regulatory requirements. Constantly pushing the boundaries and working to improve on what we already do can ensure that we remain agile, adaptable and responsive to a constantly changing environment. A. Identify inefficiencies and bottlenecks in work processes. Work as a team to develop a course of action to streamline processes, reduce waste and improve performance B. Ensure processes are aligned with Air Force goals and industry best practices. C. Research new products, services and processes to constantly improve the current practices.	
TYPE OF ASSESSMENT: PROGRESS REVIEW	Progress Review Number: 1
EMPLOYEE INPUT	
- CPI Performance I actively contribute to Continuous Process Improvement, driving efficiency, quality, and innovation in our operations. By leveraging my experience in Vulnerability Remediation, STIGs Compliance, and Standalone System Management, I effectively collaborate with the team to identify areas for improvement and support process enhancements aligned with: - Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-200, Cybersecurity - Department of Defense Instruction (DoDI) 8500.01, Cybersecurity - National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework - Federal Information Security Modernization Act (FISMA) Through ongoing research, I develop and implement new strategies to enhance vulnerability remediation, focusing on: - Robust script development for automated patching and remediation - Host-based firewall implementation for enhanced endpoint device security - Advanced STIGs compliance methodologies for improved cybersecurity posture While excelling in collaboration, process improvement knowledge, and alignment with regulatory requirements, I recognize opportunities for growth. Specifically, I aim to expand my research into emerging cybersecurity technologies and develop metrics to quantify CPI impact, positioning myself for continued growth and excellence.	
RATING OFFICIAL ASSESSMENT	
Mohan has been a great contributor to progress and innovation. He has done a good job collaborating with the work center and they have come up with some great ideas and scripts to improve processes.	

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ELEMENT NO. 6	TITLE: Service and Professionalism		
STATUS: APPROVED			
Employee consistently demonstrates a high level of proficiency in delivering exceptional service and maintaining professionalism in all interactions, reflecting positively on the organization and fostering trust and confidence among stakeholders. They exhibit a commitment to excellence, integrity, and respect in their conduct and communication, upholding the values and standards of the organization. Specifically, at the fully successful level: 1. Consistently prioritizes the needs and preferences of customers, clients, and stakeholders, demonstrating empathy, active listening, and responsiveness in addressing inquiries, concerns, and requests. Supervisor intervention will be fewer than three throughout the year. 2. Communicates clearly, courteously, and professionally in written and verbal interactions with colleagues, customers, and stakeholders, adapting communication style and tone to suit the audience and context. All customer communications to be answered within three business days. 3. Demonstrates reliability and punctuality in fulfilling job responsibilities, consistently meeting deadlines and commitments, and communicating proactively in case of any delays or unforeseen circumstances. 90% of all deadlines are met with no extensions or delays. All absences and appointments to be documented on the leave calendar. Any major work event to be updated on the events calendar.			
TYPE OF ASSESSMENT: PROGRESS REVIEW		Progress Review Number: 1	
EMPLOYEE INPUT			
- Service and Professionalism I consistently demonstrate exceptional service and professionalism, prioritizing customer (end users, other units and office staffs) needs, communicating effectively and fulfilling job responsibilities reliably. I maintain transparent communication through timely updates to the Weekly Activity Calendar (WAR) and Leave calendar, ensuring seamless coordination with colleagues and stakeholders. My commitment to reliability and punctuality is evident in consistently meeting deadlines (90%) and proactively communicating any delays. I document absences and appointments on the leave calendar, adhering to organizational procedures and respecting colleagues' time. I uphold organizational values through dedication to excellence, integrity and respect. I maintain a clean and organized workspace, respect colleagues' privacy and confidentiality and participate in knowledge-sharing sessions and training programs. I adhere to established protocols for reporting incidents and near-misses, utilize project management tools and follow data protection and cybersecurity guidelines. I demonstrate accountability for actions and decisions, prioritize tasks and manage time effectively while embracing continuous learning and professional development.			
RATING OFFICIAL ASSESSMENT			
Mr. Karki is consistently professional and proficient in all he does. He works well with leadership, co-workers and customers alike. Excellent job!			

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ELEMENT NO. 7	TITLE: Documentation
STATUS: APPROVED	
Employee consistently demonstrates a high level of proficiency in creating, maintaining, and managing documentation in accordance with organizational standards and regulatory requirements, ensuring clarity, accessibility, and compliance. They exhibit attention to detail, accuracy, and completeness in documenting processes, procedures, and information. Specifically, at the fully successful level: 1. Creates clear, comprehensive, and accurate documentation, such as Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), policies, procedures, reports, and forms, utilizing appropriate formatting, language, and structure. 2. Ensures documentation complies with organizational policies, regulatory requirements, industry standards, and best practices, incorporating relevant guidelines and standards into the documentation process. 3. Ensures documentation is easily accessible and retrievable by authorized personnel, organizing and categorizing documents effectively, and using appropriate naming conventions and metadata. 4. Completes documentation tasks within established timelines and deadlines, prioritizing work effectively to ensure timely delivery of required documentation. 5. Collaborates with relevant stakeholders, subject matter experts, and reviewers to gather input, solicit feedback, and incorporate revisions and enhancements into documentation as appropriate.	
TYPE OF ASSESSMENT: PROGRESS REVIEW	Progress Review Number: 1
EMPLOYEE INPUT	
- Documentation As an IT professional in the 102nd Intelligence Wing, Communication Squadron, I prioritize accurate, comprehensive and compliant documentation. Adhering to Department of Defense regulations, guidelines and standards is crucial, ensuring organizational policies align with DoDI 8500.01, Cybersecurity; DoDI 8510.01, Risk Management Framework; NIST Cybersecurity Framework; and FISMA, Federal Information Security Modernization Act. I create, maintain and manage documentation with precision, including Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), policies and procedures, incident response and vulnerability reports, system security plans and risk assessments. This documentation facilitates informed decision-making, audit readiness and compliance with regulatory requirements. I ensure all documentation is easily accessible, retrievable and compliant with DoD and federal regulations. Accuracy, completeness and timeliness are paramount, supported by evidence and records. By prioritizing documentation, I uphold the highest standards of cybersecurity governance and contribute to the Air Force's mission success.	
RATING OFFICIAL ASSESSMENT	
Mr. Karki has done well maintaining and creating documentation. With this being a fairly new work center, most of the documentation has to be created from scratch. The Mission Assurance work center has done a good job creating new documentation and organization system.	